

FILMS

From the first flickery film, people have loved the world of movie make-believe. The early films were made in black and white and did not have any sound. They were called silent movies. In the theater, a pianist played along with the film and the audience had to read words on the screen. It was not until 1927

that the first “talkie,” called

The Jazz Singer, came out.

Color films, such as *The Wizard of Oz* were made in 1939, but only became common in the 1950s.



Silent star

Charlie Chaplin (1889–1977) was one of the first movie stars. He starred in more than 80 films. His most famous character, “the Tramp” had a funny walk.

Moving pictures

Most films are now shot digitally, but like the first films, they are made of many still pictures called frames. The frames pass before your eyes so quickly that the pictures look as if they are moving.



Creative hub

Almost 2,000 films a year are made in India—more than double the number made in Hollywood. Streets in Mumbai and Delhi are lined with bright posters that advertise these dramatic films.



A star is born

The dry weather in California is ideal for filming. Hollywood, once a sleepy suburb of Los Angeles, was the center of the American film industry by 1920.



Cue clapboard

When a clapboard is clicked shut it is seen on the film and heard on the soundtrack. The pictures and words can then be matched.



The lighting crew sets up the lights so that the actor looks as if he is outside and not inside a bright studio.